

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 36

BY WAYS AND MEANS COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION
STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE AND EXPRESSING SUPPORT AND COMMENDATION
FOR THE IDAHO NATIONAL GUARD.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, the Idaho National Guard serves as a cornerstone of both state and national defense, fulfilling its dual mission as a state resource for emergency response and as a federal combat reserve force for the United States Army and Air Force; and

WHEREAS, the National Guard is an indispensable component of the United States National Defense Strategy, providing trained, equipped, and ready forces capable of rapid mobilization to defend the sovereignty and security of the nation at home and abroad; and

WHEREAS, the Idaho National Guard has a proud history of service to the state and nation, supporting combat operations overseas while remaining ready to respond to emergencies and disasters here at home; and

WHEREAS, the Idaho Air National Guard has distinguished itself through decades of dedicated service operating the A-10 Thunderbolt II, a formidable close air support aircraft that has protected American forces and allies across numerous combat operations and has been a source of pride for the citizens of Idaho; and

WHEREAS, the Idaho Air National Guard is now considering a historic transformation by transitioning from the A-10 Thunderbolt II to the advanced F-16 Fighting Falcon, a multirole, fourth-generation fighter jet that would significantly enhance Idaho's ability to support modern air combat and joint operations; and

WHEREAS, the Idaho Air National Guard has maintained an unbroken tradition of flying fighter aircraft in Idaho since 1947, developing highly trained airmen and distinguished combat aviation formations, and, in transitioning to the F-16 Fighting Falcon, will continue to honor and preserve its long-standing combat aviation heritage that has been part of the organization since its earliest days; and

WHEREAS, the Idaho Army National Guard is also undertaking an important force structure modernization, transitioning from an Armor Brigade Combat Team to a Mobile Brigade Combat Team, reflecting the evolving requirements of the Army's operational doctrine and the need for more agile and adaptive ground combat formations; and

WHEREAS, the Idaho Army National Guard has maintained an armored tradition in Idaho since 1949, developing generations of highly trained soldiers and distinguished armored formations, and, in transitioning to a Mobile Brigade Combat Team, will continue to honor and preserve its long-standing cavalry heritage that has been part of the organization since its earliest days; and

1 WHEREAS, these transformations, both in the air and on the ground, re-
2 flect the Idaho National Guard's continued commitment to readiness, modern-
3 ization, and alignment with the strategic priorities of the United States
4 Department of War and the State of Idaho; and

5 WHEREAS, the men and women of the Idaho National Guard have demonstrated
6 extraordinary professionalism, dedication, and sacrifice in service to the
7 State of Idaho and the United States of America, and their willingness to em-
8 brace transformational change reflects their enduring commitment to excel-
9 lence; and

10 WHEREAS, the Idaho Legislature recognizes the vital importance of sus-
11 taining robust investment, training resources, and community support for
12 the Idaho National Guard as it navigates these transitions, ensuring that
13 Idaho's guardsmen remain ready to answer the call whenever and wherever they
14 are needed.

15 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular
16 Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the House of Representatives
17 and the Senate concurring therein, that the Legislature hereby expresses its
18 wholehearted support for the Idaho National Guard's efforts to modernize its
19 force structure, recognizing the importance of both the proposed transition
20 of the Idaho Air National Guard from the A-10 Thunderbolt II to the F-16
21 Fighting Falcon and the Idaho Army National Guard's transition from an Armor
22 Brigade Combat Team to a Mobile Brigade Combat Team.

23 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature commends the soldiers and
24 airmen of the Idaho National Guard for their continued service, sacrifice,
25 and commitment to defending the State of Idaho and the United States of Amer-
26 ica, and remains committed to providing the best training, equipment, and
27 support to our Idaho National Guard.

28 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the Legislature calls on all citizens of
29 Idaho to join in recognizing and honoring the members of the Idaho National
30 Guard, our neighbors, family members, and fellow Idahoans, who stand ready
31 to serve with honor and valor.